

1. Moderators/Administrators: View these as the mayors and governors. They have extra rights and can ban people based on their activities; they basically control the forum, and are supposed to be impartial
2. Forum addicts: The hardcore enthusiasts who live and breathe online. They may be on several forums simultaneously, posting away to glory
3. Regulars: The guys/girls who make posting on a forum a regular affair, generally log on every day, and are healthy contributors
4. Occasional visitors: Members who may be online sporadically, may log in as often as twice a week, or as infrequently as once a month
5. Troublemakers: The outlaws of the forum, generally very active—even causing trouble is hard work, isn't it? The Mods are always on the lookout to bust such people. Some may have great subject knowledge, but just rebel against convention.
6. One-time visitors: Such members post just once, to solve a problem or gain some insight. Not considered to be members by the enthusiast and troublemaker categories, who take the pains to contribute regularly.

If you have a Web site with lots of—and possibly diverse—content, it's probably a very good idea to have a forum on it. This will dramatically increase traffic to your site, and apart from that, make for a more “complete” Web site experience.

9.3 Forum Packages

Let's get going with installing and getting your very own forum up and running. Here are some of the most popular forum packages for your Web site:

1. vBulletin
2. PHPBB
3. Invision Power Board
4. SMF (Simple Machines Forum)
5. Vanilla